



1378

PAPAL SCHISM

From 1309, popes resided in Avignon, dominated by the French monarchy. In 1378, Romans demanded the return of the papacy to its traditional home. Urban VI was elected pope in Rome, in opposition to Clement VII in Avignon. The two popes were joined by a third in 1409, elected in Pisa. This schism, which was finally resolved in 1417, seriously weakened papal prestige.

1383 Poland and Lithuania are unified under Wladislaw II Jagiello

1385 Portuguese victory over Castile at Aljubarrota guarantees independence under the Aviz dynasty

1381 In the Peasants' revolt, English rebels led by Wat Tyler are defeated at London

1389 A Serb-Bosnian coalition meets Ottoman forces at the first battle of Kosovo

Timur's campaigns may have caused the deaths of 17 million people

1336-1405 TRIUMPHS OF TIMUR



Timur the Lame, a Mongol warrior from Samarkand, conquered land from India to Anatolia, establishing the Timurid Empire.

1387 While campaigning in Persia and Armenia, Timur sacks the city of Isfahan and reportedly kills 70,000 of its citizens.



1395 Timur defeats his rival Tokhtamysh at the battle of Terek and breaks up the Mongol Golden Horde (helmet above).



1398 During his invasion of India, Timur defeats the Sultan of Delhi and pillages the city, bearing off his loot to Samarkand.



1402 The Ottomans are humiliated at Ankara as Timur strikes west. He imprisons the Ottoman Emperor Bayezid I in a cage.

1387

CHAUCER'S CANTERBURY TALES

English poet Geoffrey Chaucer was a courtier, diplomat, and official under Edward III and Richard II. His most famous work, *The Canterbury Tales*, is a set of stories told by a group of pilgrims travelling to the shrine of St Thomas Becket in Canterbury cathedral. A founding work of English literature, it presents a rich and varied portrait of its times. Begun in the 1380s, it was left unfinished at Chaucer's death in 1400.



△ The Ellesmere manuscript of Chaucer's *Canterbury Tales*

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